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SpaceXSI might reverse the negative sentiment on AI infrastructure investment

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SpaceXSI 三大業務超預期，全線業務扭虧轉盈，有機會帶動之前弱勢的AI族群短期復甦

ANDREW LU ON GLOBAL SEMI/TECHS
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Executive summary

SpaceXSI 公布3Q26財報，三大業務 Starlink, 火箭，AI營收，獲利大超預期，全線業務扭虧轉盈，有機會帶動之前持續弱勢的AI基礎建設及產業鏈板塊短期復甦，儘管如此，公司加碼資本開支，自由現金持續流出，估值偏高仍是值得投資人關注的風險，但 capital density 及 capital return 的季度變化相當正面，這季度AI營收趕超 CoreWeave, 明年底趕超甲骨文，SpaceXSI 應該有機會成為 NeoCloud 新龍頭。

Sales beat across all segments

SpaceXSI reports 3Q26 sales of US$14.575bn, up 87% qoq and 161% yoy, which was 13% above Bloomberg consensus estimates of US$12.875bn. 3Q26 sales beat was across all segments with a 24% sales beat on Space, 8% beat on Starlink, and 20% beat on AI.

Operating profits beat across all segments

SpaceXSI reports 3Q26 operating profits of US$2.79bn at operating margin of 19%, which was 131% higher than Bloomberg consensus estimates of US$1.21bn at operating margin of 12% and turned profits from 2Q26’s -2% operating margin. We attributed the improvement across all segments with 98% more losses cut on Space vs. consensus, 27% beat on Starlink, and US$445mn higher

profits on AI (-49% operating margin in 2Q26 to +6% in 3Q26), resulting 3Q26 adj EBITDA improvement to US$8.8bn from 2Q26's US$3.54b.

Metric	Actuals	Consensus		
Analyst				
Analyst Recommendation				
Model Download				
Table Data Date	10/20/2026	10/20/2026		
Highlights				
Adjusted Diluted EPS	0.35	0.15	28	138.27%
Revenue	14,575.00	12,874.85	33	13.21%
▾ Space				
# of Rocket Launches (Actual)	35.00	40.62	11	-13.83%
Mass to Orbit (Metric Tons)	476.00	558.79	5	-14.82%
▾ Starlink				
# of Subscribers (Thousands)	13,600.00	14,230.43	19	-4.43%
Avg. Revenue per User ($ pe...	69.00	65.05	18	6.07%
Number of Satellites in Orbit		10,643.00	5	
▾ Space				
Revenue	1,767.00	1,428.65	23	23.68%
Operating Income	-7.00	-323.04	20	97.83%
Adjusted EBITDA	357.00	123.11	19	189.99%
Capital Expenditures	1,606.00	1,519.45	19	5.70%
▾ Connectivity				
Revenue	5,248.00	4,857.72	23	8.03%
Operating Income	2,367.00	1,862.82	21	27.07%
Adjusted EBITDA	3,499.00	2,936.21	20	19.17%
Capital Expenditures	1,543.00	1,598.59	20	-3.48%
▾ AI				
Revenue	7,560.00	6,304.54	22	19.91%
Operating Income	431.00	-13.55	21	3,281.12%
Adjusted EBITDA	4,953.00	3,321.00	18	49.14%
Capital Expenditures	16,444.00	16,897.81	19	-2.69%

Source: Bloomberg estimates

付費訂閱讀者可分享我們對 SpaceXSI 資本開支增加，自由現金流出，capital density 及capital return 變化，趕超 CoreWeave，甲骨文的看法

Subscribed

Cutting capital density despite capex hike and negative free cash flow

Given SpaceXSI continues to boost its 3Q26 capex to US$19.593bn, up 7% qoq and 185% yoy, coupled with short of cash flow from operations (US$9.63bn), the company reports a negative free cash flow of nearly US$10bn. However, due to a stronger than expected sales improvement, capital density was cut to 134% in 3Q26 from 2Q26's 235%.

Unit in US$bn	1Q25A	2Q25A	3Q26A	1Q26A	2Q26A	3Q26A	4Q26E
Starlink	2.48	2.59	3.10	3.26	4.29	5.25	5.79
Space	0.87	0.75	1.67	0.62	0.96	1.77	1.49
AI	0.73	0.74	0.81	0.82	2.56	7.56	8.62
Total sales	4.07	4.07	5.58	4.69	7.81	14.58	15.89
YoY				15%	92%	161%	103%
COGS	1.96	2.28	2.71	2.39	3.50	5.48	7.14
Depreciation	1.44	1.53	1.81	2.44	2.85	3.64	4.78
Gross profits	2.11	1.79	2.87	2.31	4.32	9.10	8.76
Gross %	52%	44%	51%	49%	55%	62%	55%
Op expenses	2.08	2.76	3.14	4.25	4.46	6.31	7.46
Operating profits	0.03	(0.97)	(0.27)	(1.94)	(0.14)	2.79	1.30
Op margin %	1%	-24%	-5%	-41%	-2%	19%	8%
Others	(0.54)	0.10	(0.22)	(2.33)	(0.20)	1.22	(0.44)
Pretax	(0.51)	(0.87)	(0.49)	(4.27)	(0.35)	4.01	0.86
Taxes	(0.01)	(0.14)	(0.56)	(0.01)	(0.02)	0.39	0.13
Net income	(0.53)	(1.01)	(1.05)	(4.28)	(0.37)	4.40	0.99
Net margin %	-13%	-25%	-19%	-91%	-5%	30%	6%
Shares in bn	2.93	2.93	2.94	4.06	5.86	12.48	12.48
GAAP EPS in US$	(0.18)	(0.34)	(0.36)	(1.05)	(0.06)	0.35	0.08
Capex	4.14	2.83	6.88	10.11	18.37	19.59	22.30
Capital density %	102%	69%	123%	215%	235%	134%	140%
adj EBITDA	1.73	1.21	2.17	1.13	3.54	8.81	10.51
adj EBITDA/share	0.59	0.41	0.74	0.28	0.60	0.71	0.84
Gross FCF	(2.41)	(1.61)	(4.71)	(8.98)	(14.83)	(10.78)	(11.79)
Operating profits							
Starlink	1.19	0.92	1.19	1.19	1.66	2.37	2.42
Space	0.26	(0.37)	0.26	(0.66)	(0.54)	(0.01)	(0.35)
AI	-1.722	(1.52)	(1.72)	(2.47)	(1.26)	0.43	2.40
Operating margin %							
Starlink	48%	36%	38%	36%	39%	45%	42%
Space	30%	-49%	16%	-107%	-56%	0%	-24%
AI	-237%	-207%	-212%	-302%	-49%	6%	28%
Adj EBITDA							
Starlink	1.92	1.58	1.92	2.09	2.60	3.50	3.62
Space	0.67	(0.09)	0.67	(0.35)	(0.21)	0.36	0.10
AI	(0.43)	(0.28)	(0.43)	(0.61)	1.15	4.95	6.79
Adj EBITDA %							
Starlink	78%	61%	62%	64%	61%	67%	63%
Space	78%	-12%	40%	-57%	-21%	20%	7%
AI	-59%	-37%	-53%	-74%	45%	66%	79%

Source: SpaceXSI, Andrew Lu on global semis/techs

Passing CoreWeave, catching Oracle on AI business

SpaceXSI reports US$7.56bn on AI business in 3Q26, up 195% qoq and 830% yoy, growth accelerated from 2Q26's 247% yoy. AI business in 3Q26 accounted for 52% of SpaceXSI total sales, up from 33% in 2Q26. As a result, we estimate SpaceXSI AI business to exceed CoreWeave sales in 3Q26 and might exceed Oracle cloud sales by 4Q27. Driven by a dramatic operating margin improvement on AI business in 3Q26, we see a 100ppts qoq improvement on capital return on AI sales and profits.

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